



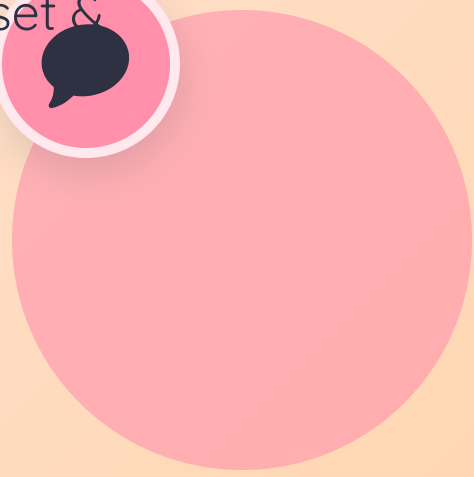
PAUL IREIFEJ · INTERACTIVE WORKSHOP

Find Your Voice / Speak So Others Will Listen



A 50-Minute Interactive Intensive on Spontaneous Presence, Somatic Reset &
Applied Improv

Facilitated by Paul Ireifej



PATTERN INTERRUPT

0:00–4:00

I Am **NOT** Qualified to Lead This Workshop

“I fought to claim every syllable.
That is why I know the high stakes
of silence, tension, and what it truly
means to not have a voice.”

⌘ The core shift

Theoretical orators can sound polished and still miss the room. We are moving from **corporate recital** to genuine human resonance.

A stutter taught me that communication is not flawless delivery. It is the courage to stay present when the words matter.

WHOLE-ROOM DRILL

4:00–8:00

The Body Speaks First: **Vocal & Physical Reset**

A gentle, comfortable reset before we ask the voice to do more. Nothing forced; keep your movement easy and within your range.



01

Cervical & Laryngeal Release

Try a gentle neck roll, jaw release, and shoulder reset. Notice where you are holding tension; do not force your neck.



02

Motor Resonance

Lip trills or a soft motorboat buzz can explore steady airflow without straining the vocal folds.



03

Forward Placement

Use an easy “mmm-mmm” buzz. Let the sound feel forward rather than pushed from the back of the throat.

TEACHING BLOCK

8:00–11:00

Perfection is the Enemy of Presence

Stanford's "Dare to be Dull" reframe gives you permission to stop auditioning for brilliance.



The brilliant-thing trap

When every sentence has to impress, the mind can freeze. We edit in real time, lose the thread, and stop listening.



Dare to be useful

Drop the urge to say the perfect thing. Offer the next honest, workable thought. Spontaneous connection has room to arrive.

The Energy Drain: “Yes, But...” vs. “Yes, And...”

Turn to **your neighbor**. Choose Person A and Person B. For 60 seconds, plan an event using strictly “Yes, but...”

1. Propose

Person A offers an event idea.

2. Block politely

Person B begins every reply: “Yes, but...”

3. Notice

Where does momentum stall? What happens to your energy?

 60 seconds

Polite objection can stall momentum, trigger defensiveness, and create conversational deadlock.

The Penguin Protocol: Group “Yes, And...”

“A colony of penguins just took over the corporate breakroom.”



Accept

Treat the prior sentence as unquestioned fact.



Add

Add one sentence beginning with “Yes, and...”



Pass

Send the story to the next volunteer.

Key lesson: absurd premises can quiet analytical self-censorship and level the room.

MEETING REALITY CHECK

20:00-24:00

Applied Improv in **Tough Meetings**



Accept the Offer

Treat curveballs and objections as data, not attacks.



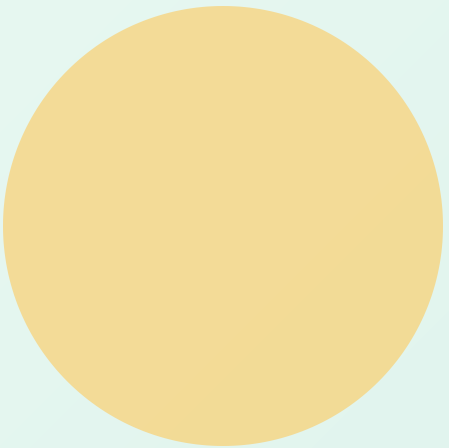
Lower the Stakes

Silence internal critics; trust the experience you already carry.



Build the Bridge

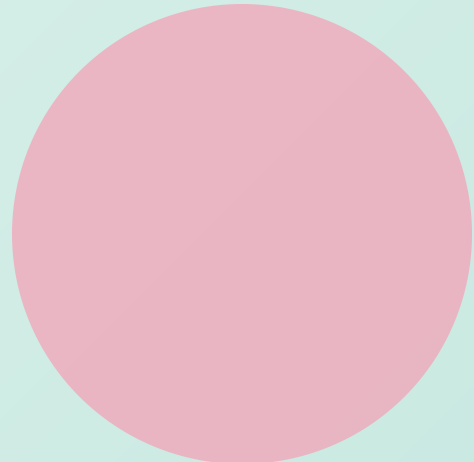
Validate their reality before you steer toward an outcome.



PART TWO

The Rapid-Thinking Framework

Structure sets you free: instant containers for real-time clarity



CORE FRAMEWORK

24:00–29:00

The PREP Model for Spontaneous Clarity

P

Point

Lead with the bottom line in one sentence.

R

Reason

Name the fundamental why or strategic rationale.

E

Evidence / Story

Give one concrete fact, metric, or real-life example.

P

Point Action

Reiterate the conclusion with a clear call to action.

EXERCISE 2 · PARTNER SPRINT

45

SECONDS
ZERO ADVANCE PREP

29:00–35:00

The 45-Second **PREP** Sprint

Rapid turn-and-talk with your neighbor. Partner A gets a surprise prompt and delivers Point, Reason, Evidence, Point. Then switch roles with a new prompt.

Example surprise prompts: “Should meetings be 25 minutes?” ·
“What is one process we should simplify?”

LIVE FACILITATOR COACHING

35:00–42:00

The Hot-Seat: Handling the Interruption

One volunteer takes the mic. We practice the protocol under a little pressure.

1

Take a 2-second breath. Replace panic fillers with confident silence.

2

Acknowledge the interruption. Start with “Yes, and...” to show you heard the offer.

3

Anchor back. Return to a tight PREP conclusion.

EXECUTIVE PRESENCE INSIGHT

2.0_s

THE MICRO-PAUSE

42:00-45:00

The 2.0-Second Micro-Pause

Dead air can feel like an eternity to the speaker. To the listener, a short pause can signal composure, authority, and confidence.

Try it before your next answer. Let the thought land, then speak.

Scripted Oratory vs. Spontaneous Presence

Dimension	Scripted Oratory	Spontaneous Presence
Objective	Deliver the words correctly.	Connect around a useful idea.
Reaction to Pushback	Defend the plan or return to script.	Accept the data; build a bridge.
Physical State	Braced, managed, over-controlled.	Grounded, breathable, responsive.
Mental Architecture	Memorized sequence.	Flexible containers: Yes, And + PREP.
Room Impact	Polished, but potentially distant.	Clear, human, and easier to trust.



CLOSING CALL TO ACTION

Finding Your Voice is a **Daily Habit**



The 60-Second Morning Rep

Pick a household object or headline. Start a timer. Deliver a PREP response out loud.

Your voice matters most when it isn't scripted.

Speak to connect.

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